

Workplace Safety Guidelines

Office Safety

All Contoso offices maintain marked emergency exits, fire extinguishers inspected quarterly, and a designated floor warden for each office level responsible for coordinating evacuations during drills and real emergencies. Floor wardens are trained annually and their names are posted on each floor's safety board along with a backup warden in case the primary is out of office.

Reporting Incidents

Any workplace injury, however minor, must be reported to Facilities and HR within 24 hours using the Incident Report Form, even if the employee does not seek medical treatment, so that any pattern of hazards can be identified early — for example, three separate minor slip reports near the same entrance in one month would trigger a facilities review of that specific area.

Ergonomics

Employees may request a free ergonomic assessment of their home or office workstation through the Workplace Safety team. Assessments typically result in recommendations for chair height, monitor position, and keyboard placement, and may result in approval for an ergonomic equipment purchase beyond the standard remote work equipment stipend if the assessment identifies a genuine need.

Emergency Procedures

In the event of a fire alarm, employees must evacuate immediately via the nearest marked exit and gather at their office's designated assembly point; re-entry is not permitted until the floor warden or emergency services confirm it is safe. Employees with a mobility limitation that affects evacuation should register with Facilities in advance so a specific evacuation plan (for example, using a designated evacuation chair) is prepared ahead of any actual emergency.

Severe weather procedures (tornado, earthquake, or similar regional hazards) differ by office location and are posted on each floor's safety board separately from the standard fire evacuation route, since sheltering in place is often the correct response for these hazards rather than evacuating the building.

Workplace Violence Prevention

Contoso Corp has zero tolerance for threats or acts of violence in the workplace, whether from an employee, client, or visitor. Any concern about a potential threat, even one that seems minor or ambiguous, should be reported immediately to Facilities Security and HR rather than waiting to see if

the situation escalates.

Hazardous Materials Handling

Offices with a print shop, lab space, or maintenance area maintain Safety Data Sheets for every chemical product on site, accessible through the Workplace Safety team's shared binder or portal. Employees who are not specifically trained and authorized should never attempt to clean up a chemical spill themselves; Facilities has a dedicated response protocol for this.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to report a near-miss (no injury, but something almost went wrong)? Yes — near-misses are specifically encouraged to be reported, since they often reveal a hazard before it actually causes an injury; the Incident Report Form has a specific near-miss option distinct from an actual injury report.

Who pays for a workers' compensation claim from a workplace injury? Workers' compensation insurance, which Contoso Corp carries as required by law, covers medical costs and partial wage replacement for a qualifying workplace injury; the employee does not pay out of pocket for a covered claim, and using workers' compensation does not count against an employee's PTO balance.

Roles and Responsibilities

Facilities maintains building safety equipment and coordinates floor wardens. The Workplace Safety team runs ergonomic assessments and safety training. Every employee is responsible for reporting hazards, injuries, and near-misses promptly, regardless of how minor they may seem.